VOLUME 5 AIRMAN CERTIFICATION

CHAPTER 2 TITLE 14 CFR PART 61 CERTIFICATION OF PILOTS AND FLIGHT INSTRUCTORS

Section 12 Conduct a Title 14 CFR Part 61 Flight Instructor with a Sport Pilot Rating Initial Certification, Additional Category/Class Privilege, Recent Experience Validation, or Reinstatement of Privileges

Source Basis:

- **Title 14 CFR § 61.23, Medical Certificates: Requirement and Duration.**
- **Title 14 CFR § 61.43, Practical Tests: General Procedures.**
- **Title 14 CFR § 61.49, Retesting After Failure.**
- **Title 14 CFR § 61.51, Pilot Logbooks.**
- **Title 14 CFR Part 61 Subpart J, Sport Pilots.**
- **Title 14 CFR Part 61 Subpart K, Flight Instructors With a Sport Pilot Rating.**
- **Title 14 CFR Part 61, Certification: Pilots, Flight Instructors, and Ground Instructors.**

5-531 REPORTING SYSTEM(S). Use Safety Assurance System (SAS) Activity Recording (AR) and use the following activity codes, as appropriate:

A. Original Certification: 1525.

B. Reinstatement: 1529.

C. Additional Category or Class Privilege: 1526.

D. Recent Experience: 1527 (Flight) and 1528 (No Flight).

5-532 OBJECTIVE. This task determines if an applicant meets the requirements for an initial flight instructor certificate with a sport pilot rating, an additional category or class privilege, establishment of flight instructor recent experience, or the reinstatement of privileges for a flight instructor certificate with a sport pilot rating. Completion of this task may result in the issuance of a Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) Form 8060-4, Temporary Airman Certificate; an FAA Form 8060-5, Notice of Disapproval of Application; or a Letter of Discontinuance, as appropriate. When no flight is involved for the establishment or reestablishment of recent flight instructor experience, a Temporary Airman Certificate may not be required.

5-533 GENERAL.

A. The Delegation and Resource Branch (AFG-970). AFG-970 provides standardization and support for the Safety Assurance offices in the implementation of this rule. AFG-970 will provide support either directly through the branch or through the Flight Standards Inspector Resource Program (FSIRP) when a Sport Pilot Flight Instructor Examiner (SPFIE) is unavailable to administer practical tests for the original issuance, recent experience, or reinstatement of flight instructor privileges.

B. Aviation Safety Inspector (ASI) and Aviation Safety Technician (AST) Qualifications.

1) An Operations ASI conducting a practical test for a flight instructor certificate with sport pilot rating or a proficiency check for a category or class privilege must:

- Hold the appropriate pilot and flight instructor rating/privilege for the practical test or proficiency check being administered.
- Meet the applicable requirements of Volume 1, Chapter 3, Sections 4, 6, and 10, and Volume 5, Chapter 1, Section 2.
- Have completed on-the-job training (OJT) for that task.
- Coordinate with AFG-970.

2) Operations and Flight Oversight ASIs and ASTs may evaluate the application from a flight instructor who is applying to establish recent flight instructor experience (i.e., not by practical test or proficiency check) or to reestablish recent flight instructor experience using a flight instructor refresher course (FIRC) within 3 calendar months after the month of the recent flight instructor experience period ended. They must:

- Have completed OJT for this task.
- Meet the applicable requirements of Volume 1, Chapter 3, Section 4 (ASI only).

C. Airworthiness Qualification.

1) Prior to conducting the practical test or proficiency check, the evaluator or an Airworthiness ASI shall review the applicant's aircraft maintenance records, aircraft logbooks, Airworthiness Certificate, and aircraft registration to determine if the aircraft is eligible and suitable for this practical test. After review, return the documents to the applicant.

2) During the practical test or proficiency check, the applicant will review the aircraft maintenance records, logbooks, Airworthiness Certificate, and aircraft registration for the purpose of demonstrating aeronautical knowledge about how to determine whether an aircraft is airworthy. If the applicant is taking a practical test or proficiency check in an airplane or glider because the applicant previously failed a test or check based on not meeting the requirements to teach stall awareness, spin entry, spins, and spin recovery procedures, then the evaluator must verify that the aircraft to be used is certificated for spins, if applicable.

5-534 ESTABLISHING ELIGIBILITY.

A. Eligibility Requirements. To be eligible for a flight instructor certificate with a sport pilot rating, an applicant must be at least 18 years of age; hold at least a current FAA Form 8500-9, Medical Certificate Third-Class, be eligible under BasicMed, or hold a valid U.S. driver's license; hold a sport pilot certificate or higher; and meet the applicable requirements of Title 14 of the Code of Federal Regulations (14 CFR) part 61 subpart K.

B. Airman Medical Certification Requirements. An applicant for an initial flight instructor certificate with a sport pilot rating, adding a category or class privilege, or for establishing recent experience or reinstatement of flight instructor privileges is required to hold at least a current third-class medical certificate or a valid U.S. driver's license if the practical test or proficiency check is administered in an aircraft in flight (e.g., in an airplane, airship, gyroplane, weight-shift-control, or powered parachute). If operating under BasicMed in lieu of possessing a valid medical certificate, a valid U.S. driver's license as well as a current Certificate of Completion from an authorized BasicMed medical education course is required.

1) If the applicant does not hold a medical certificate or valid U.S. driver's license and the practical test will be administered in an aircraft (e.g., airplane, airship, gyroplane, weight-shift-control, or powered parachute), the applicant must request the evaluator to agree to be the pilot in command (PIC). However, the evaluator is not required to agree to be the PIC. Evaluators who agree to perform PIC duties during a practical test are advised to review 14 CFR § 61.47. Evaluators must understand that there are possible legal liability and ramifications when agreeing to perform PIC duties during the practical test.

2) If the medical certificate bears any limitation that would require a special medical flight test necessary, refer the applicant to AFG-970.

NOTE: BasicMed is required only for sport pilot privileges being exercised at night. All other privileges only require the airman to hold a valid driver's license.

C. English Language. See Volume 5, Chapter 2, Section 1 for details.

5-535 GENERAL PROCEDURES FOR INITIAL CERTIFICATION.

A. Logbook Endorsements. An applicant for a flight instructor certificate with a sport pilot rating must present a logbook or training record with the following endorsements, as appropriate, from an authorized flight instructor. The endorsements should be similar to the sample endorsements provided in Advisory Circular (AC) 61-65, Certification: Pilots and Flight and Ground Instructors.

1) Except as provided in 14 CFR § 61.407(c), an applicant for a flight instructor certificate with a sport pilot rating must have logged training and received a logbook endorsement on the fundamentals of instruction listed in 14 CFR § 61.407(a).

2) The applicant's logbook or training record must contain an endorsement from an authorized instructor who certifies the applicant has received and logged training within 2 calendar months preceding the date of the application in preparation for the practical test (refer to 14 CFR § 61.39(a)(6)(i)).

3) The applicant's logbook or training record must contain an endorsement from an authorized instructor who certifies the applicant is prepared for the practical test. In addition, the applicant must have an FAA Form 8710-11, Airman Certificate and/or Rating Application – Sport Pilot, with the authorized instructor's signature.

4) The applicant's logbook or training record must contain an endorsement from an authorized instructor that states the applicant has demonstrated satisfactory knowledge of the subject areas in which the applicant was deficient on the airman knowledge test, as appropriate.

5) An applicant must have received flight instruction and a logbook endorsement from an authorized instructor to meet the requirements of 14 CFR § 61.409 in the subjects appropriate to the flight instructor with a sport pilot rating.

6) An applicant must have logged training and received a logbook endorsement from an authorized instructor on the training required by 14 CFR § 61.411 that is appropriate to the flight instructor with a sport pilot rating.

7) An applicant for a flight instructor certificate with sport pilot rating and with airplane privileges or with glider privileges must present a logbook endorsement from an authorized instructor that indicates that the applicant is competent and possesses instructional proficiency in stall awareness, spin entry, spins, and spin recovery procedures in an airplane or glider, as appropriate.

a) Except in the case of a retest after a failure for the deficiencies stated in 14 CFR § 61.49(b), the examiner may either accept this logbook endorsement or require the applicant to demonstrate competency and instructional proficiency in stall awareness, spin entry, spins, and spin recovery procedures.

b) If FAA Form 8060-5 was issued due to deficiencies in competency and instructional proficiency in stall awareness, spin entry, spins, and spin recovery procedures, the applicant is required to demonstrate on the retest competency and instructional proficiency in stall awareness, spin entry, spins, and spin recovery procedures in the applicable category and class of aircraft that is certified for spins.

c) The evaluator and the applicant are not required to wear parachutes for the spin task demonstration during a flight instructor practical test.

B. Knowledge Test. The applicant must meet the aeronautical knowledge requirements of 14 CFR § 61.405(a). The flight instructor knowledge test consists of two tests: fundamentals of instructing (FOI) and a flight instructor sport pilot knowledge test appropriate to the category privileges sought.

1) FOI Test Alternate Criteria. An applicant for the original issuance of a flight instructor certificate need not take the FOI test if the applicant meets certain alternate criteria. However, the applicant must present appropriate documentation to the FAA office or AFG-970 and obtain an authorization to use either of the following in lieu of the FOI knowledge test:

a) A current teacher's certificate issued by a state, county, city, or municipality that authorizes the person to teach at an educational level of the 7th grade or higher; or

b) Evidence of regular employment as a teacher at an accredited college or university.

2) Practical Test for Flight Instructor with Sport Pilot Rating. An applicant must receive a logbook endorsement from the authorized instructor who trained them on the applicable areas of operation specified in 14 CFR § 61.409, certifying the applicant has met the aeronautical knowledge for the category and class flight instructor privilege sought.

a) Aeronautical Experience. The applicant must present acceptable evidence of meeting the minimum aeronautical experience requirements of 14 CFR § 61.411.

b) Aeronautical Skill. The original issuance of a flight instructor certificate with a sport pilot rating will be issued by an SPFIE or Operations ASI. The applicant must demonstrate aeronautical skill by satisfactorily completing the practical test prescribed by 14 CFR § 61.405(b). The test will be conducted in accordance with the appropriate sport pilot practical test standards (PTS)/Airman Certification Standards (ACS). The evaluator may also require the applicant to demonstrate knowledge and skill from other PTS/ACS that may include sport pilot certificate or private pilot certificate, if appropriate.

C. Category and Class Privileges. A flight instructor certificate with a sport pilot rating does not list aircraft category ratings. When the practical test for a flight instructor certificate with a sport pilot rating is successfully passed, a logbook endorsement is provided by the evaluator for the category and class privileges authorized (refer to 14 CFR § 61.417).

5-536 GENERAL PROCEDURES FOR RECENT EXPERIENCE OR REINSTATEMENT. A qualified Operations ASI or SPFIE evaluator is authorized to administer a practical test for the establishment of recent experience or reinstatement of privileges for a flight instructor certificate with a sport pilot rating. Issuing the recent experience or reinstatement of flight instructor privileges is based on the applicant satisfactorily accomplishing a practical test (e.g., the oral and flight portions), as required by 14 CFR § 61.197(b)(1). The evaluator may require an applicant for recent experience or reinstatement of privileges to complete all or any portion of the flight instructor certificate with sport pilot rating practical test that the evaluator deems necessary to determine the applicant's competence to hold a flight instructor certificate with sport pilot rating. However, as a minimum the evaluator must evaluate the areas of operation and tasks designated in the appropriate flight instructor certificate with sport pilot rating PTS or ACS, as appropriate.

A. Endorsement Not Required. A flight instructor endorsement is not required for the recent experience or reinstatement of flight instructor privileges except in accordance with the provisions of 14 CFR § 61.49 for a retest.

B. Flight Instructor Certificates with Expiration Dates. Flight instructor certificates issued after December 1, 2024, are issued without an expiration date. In accordance with 14 CFR § 61.19(d)(2), a flight instructor certificate issued before December 1, 2024, expires 24 calendar months from the month in which it was issued, renewed, or reinstated, as appropriate. In accordance with 14 CFR § 61.425, a person who holds an unexpired flight instructor certificate with sport pilot rating issued before December 1, 2024, may renew that certificate by establishing recent experience in accordance with 14 CFR § 61.197(b) prior to the month of expiration on that person's flight instructor certificate. Except as provided in 14 CFR § 61.40, if that person fails to establish recent experience prior to the expiration of that person's flight

instructor certificate, that person may not exercise flight instructor privileges until those privileges are reinstated in accordance with 14 CFR § 61.427.

C. Evaluator Qualifications for Recent Experience or Reinstatement of Privileges for Applicants with Multiple Category Privileges. In order to administer a practical test for the recent experience or reinstatement privileges for a flight instructor certificate with a sport pilot rating, with more than one aircraft category privilege, an evaluator must be qualified in at least the category of aircraft to be used for the practical test.

D. Establishing Recent Experience for All Flight Instructor Privileges. An applicant may establish recent experience for all privileges of their current flight instructor certificate by satisfactorily completing one practical test. The satisfactory completion of a practical test for an additional flight instructor privilege reestablishes recent experience for all flight instructor privileges listed in the applicant's logbook.

E. Recent Experience of Category Privileges by Other Than a Practical Test. A qualified evaluator may validate recent experience for holders of a flight instructor certificate with a sport pilot rating provided that the recent experience only involves an administrative process and no practical test is involved. Specifically, an evaluator's authority to validate recent experience applications for holders of a flight instructor certificate with a sport pilot rating involves the following recent experience procedures only:

1) In accordance with 14 CFR § 61.197(b)(2)(i), flight instructors who apply to establish recent experience on the basis of having trained and endorsed, during the preceding 24 calendar months, at least five applicants for a practical test for a certificate, rating, or privilege and at least 80 percent of those applicants passed that test on the first attempt.

2) In accordance with 14 CFR § 61.197(b)(2)(ii), flight instructors who apply to establish recent experience based on serving, during the preceding 24 calendar months, as a company check pilot, chief flight instructor, company check airman, or flight instructor in a 14 CFR part 121 or 135 operation, or in a position involving the regular evaluations of pilots. See Volume 5, Chapter 2, Section 11, Subparagraph 5-504C, Title 14 CFR § 61.197(b)(2)(ii) Recent Experience Requirements, for further information.

3) In accordance with 14 CFR § 61.197(b)(2)(iii), flight instructors who apply to establish recent experience on the basis of a graduation certificate that shows, within the preceding 3 calendar months prior to the date of application, the applicant has successfully completed an approved FIRC.

4) In accordance with 14 CFR § 61.197(b)(2)(iv), flight instructors who apply to establish recent experience on the basis of passing, during the preceding 24 calendar months, an official U.S. Armed Forces military instructor pilot or pilot examiner proficiency check.

5) In accordance with 14 CFR § 61.197(b)(2)(v), flight instructors who apply to establish recent experience on the basis of having served, during the preceding 24 calendar months, as a flight instructor in an FAA-sponsored pilot proficiency program (i.e., the FAA's Pilot Proficiency Program (WINGS)), have completed at least one phase of that pilot proficiency program in the preceding 12 calendar months, and have given flight training for at least

15 accredited flight activities in that program during which the flight instructor evaluated at least 5 different pilots and made appropriate endorsements in the each pilot's logbook or training record. See Volume 5, Chapter 2, Section 11, subparagraph 5-504B2)e) for further information.

F. Reinstatement of Privileges. In accordance with 14 CFR § 61.425, a holder of flight instructor certificate with a sport pilot rating who has not complied with the recent experience requirements of 14 CFR § 61.197 may not exercise the privileges of that certificate after the end of their most recent 24 calendar month recent experience period. A person whose flight instructor privileges have lapsed may have those privileges reinstated in accordance with 14 CFR § 61.427 by completing one of the following reinstatement requirements:

1) If 3 calendar months or less have passed since the last month of the flight instructor's recent experience period, the flight instructor may successfully complete an approved FIRC. If more than 3 calendar months have passed since the last month of the flight instructor's recent experience period, the instructor may not reinstate flight instructor privileges by completing an approved FIRC.

2) If more than 3 calendar months have passed since the last month of the flight instructor's recent experience period, that instructor must pass a practical test as prescribed in 14 CFR § 61.405(b) or 14 CFR § 61.183(h) for one of the ratings listed on their flight instructor certificate with a sport pilot rating. The FAA will reinstate any privilege authorized by that flight instructor certificate with a sport pilot rating.

5-537 DENIAL OF AN APPLICATION FOR RECENT EXPERIENCE OR REINSTATEMENT OF PRIVILEGES BASED ON A DISAPPROVED PRACTICAL TEST. If an applicant is unable to meet the requirements for flight instructor recent experience or reinstatement of privileges by satisfactorily completing the applicable practical test, the evaluator issues the applicant an FAA Form 8060-5. If recent experience or reinstatement of privileges has been denied on the basis of the applicant's piloting proficiency, the evaluator should document the deficiencies and contact AFG-970 for possible reexamination consideration. Except for a retest, the FAA does not require a flight instructor recommendation for the recent experience or reinstatement of flight instructor privileges. However, a flight instructor may recommend additional preparation to the flight instructor with sport pilot rating applicant.

5-538 GOLD SEAL FLIGHT INSTRUCTOR CERTIFICATES. A qualified flight instructor may request the issuance of a Gold Seal Flight Instructor Certificate when reestablishing their flight instructor recent experience or at any time the flight instructor makes application upon meeting the requirements. Only ASI and AST evaluators are authorized to issue the initial gold seal on a flight instructor certificate with sport pilot rating. An evaluator who is authorized to validate flight instructor recent experience may validate a new recent experience period or reinstate flight instructor privileges for a flight instructor with a gold seal on their flight instructor certificate.

A. Gold Seal Requirements. If flight instructor with sport pilot rating applicant is applying for a gold seal certificate, see Volume 5, Chapter 2, Section 13 to determine eligibility.

B. Renewal of a Gold Seal Certificate. The holder of a Gold Seal Flight Instructor Certificate is not required to meet the criteria for the gold seal again. A flight instructor who qualifies for a gold seal certificate is entitled to receive another gold seal certificate on any reissuance of that flight instructor certificate and retains the gold seal when reestablishing a new recent experience period or reinstating privileges.

5-539 CATEGORY AND CLASS PRIVILEGES FOR A FLIGHT INSTRUCTOR CERTIFICATE WITH A SPORT PILOT RATING. The following aircraft category and class privileges are issued through logbook endorsements for a flight instructor certificate with a sport pilot rating, as applicable:

- Airplane single-engine land or sea.
- Rotorcraft gyroplane.
- Rotorcraft helicopter–simplified flight controls.
- Weight-shift-control.
- Powered-parachute.
- Lighter-than-air airship.
- Lighter-than-air balloon.
- Glider.

5-540 ADDITIONAL CATEGORY AND CLASS PRIVILEGES FOR A FLIGHT INSTRUCTOR CERTIFICATE WITH A SPORT PILOT RATING.

A. Adding Category and Class Privileges.

1) Applicants who hold a sport pilot certificate and want to instruct in an additional category or class of aircraft must:

a) Receive a logbook endorsement from the authorized instructor who trained them on the applicable areas of operation specified in 14 CFR § 61.409 certifying they have met the aeronautical knowledge and flight proficiency requirements for the additional category and class flight instructor privilege sought.

b) Make application on an FAA Form 8710-11 for a proficiency check or practical test (as appropriate), have it endorsed by the recommending instructor, and make it available to the evaluator who will administer the check.

c) Successfully complete a proficiency check from an authorized evaluator on the areas specified in 14 CFR § 61.409 for the additional category and class flight instructor privilege sought, except for airplane or rotorcraft helicopter categories.

2) In order to add airplane or helicopter, an applicant must complete a practical test with a Designated Examiner or ASI per 14 CFR § 61.321(b).

B. Aircraft with Simplified Flight Controls Designations—Adding a Make and Model Privilege. An individual who seeks to operate a helicopter–simplified flight controls or any aircraft with a simplified flight controls designation must, per 14 CFR § 61.31(l), receive and

log model-specific flight training from an authorized instructor in that aircraft, or in a full flight simulator (FFS) or flight training device (FTD) that is representative of that model-specific aircraft with the simplified flight controls in each make and model. Title 14 CFR § 61.31(l) also requires that they must also receive a logbook endorsement from an authorized instructor who has found the person proficient in the safe operation of that model-specific aircraft and the associated simplified flight controls. Instructors who wish to exercise the privileges of their flight instructor certificate in a model-specific aircraft that has a simplified flight controls designation must meet the training and endorsement requirements specified in 14 CFR § 61.31(l) prior to providing any flight training in that aircraft.

NOTE: Title 14 CFR § 61.31(l) applies to all persons who wish to operate an aircraft with a simplified flight controls designation, not just to those who hold a sport pilot certificate.

C. Certification. Successful applicants will receive a logbook endorsement from the authorized evaluator who administered the proficiency check or practical test certifying that they are proficient and authorized for the additional category and class flight instructor privilege.

D. Submission of FAA Form 8710-11. The authorized evaluator will complete, sign, and submit the FAA Form 8710-11 application to the Airmen Certification Branch (AFB-720).

5-541 LIMITATIONS. There is no provision for an evaluator to issue operating limitations on a flight instructor certificate.

5-542 PREREQUISITES AND COORDINATION REQUIREMENTS.

A. Prerequisites. This task requires knowledge of 14 CFR part 61 subpart K and familiarity with the PTS or ACS, as appropriate, for sport pilot flight instructor practical tests. An ASI or an AST must meet the additional qualifications established in subparagraph 5-533B above.

B. Coordination. This task may require coordination with AFG-970, the airworthiness unit of a Flight Standards District Office (FSDO), or with AFB-720.

5-543 REFERENCES, FORMS, AND JOB AIDS.

A. References (current editions):

- AC 61-65, Certification: Pilots and Flight and Ground Instructors.
- Title 14 CFR Parts 61, 91, and 141.

B. Forms:

- FAA Form 8060-4, Temporary Airman Certificate.
- FAA Form 8060-5, Notice of Disapproval of Application.
- FAA Form 8710-11, Airman Certificate and/or Rating Application – Sport Pilot.

C. Job Aids. Sample letters and figures.

5-544 PROCEDURES.

A. Schedule Appointment. Advise the applicant to bring the following documents to the appointment:

1) The applicant must present a pilot logbook or other acceptable and reliable record(s) as evidence of having met the required aeronautical experience for the certificate, rating, or privilege sought that substantiates the aeronautical experience shown on the FAA Form 8710-11 application (see Figure 5-53, Sample FAA Form 8710-11, Application for a Flight Instructor Privilege for Sport Pilot).

2) The applicant must present a completed and signed FAA Form 8710-11 application. As a special emphasis item, the evaluator must review the applicant's aeronautical experience recorded on the FAA Form 8710-11 application and in the applicant's logbook/training record to ensure that the appropriate aeronautical experience requirements for the certificate, rating, or privilege sought have been met. In the record of pilot time on the FAA Form 8710-11 application, the applicant must list at least the aeronautical experience required for the airman certificate and rating sought. Graduates of 14 CFR part 141 pilot schools or 14 CFR part 142 training centers must provide their aeronautical experience in the record of pilot time on the FAA Form 8710-11 application, even though the graduation certificate is evidence of having completed the course of training. If aeronautical experience has no bearing on the airman certification action being sought, it is not necessary for an applicant to complete the record of pilot time on the FAA Form 8710-11 application. Applications to establish flight instructor recent experience or reinstate flight instructor privileges are examples for which aeronautical experience would not have a bearing on the airman certification action. However, all applicants are encouraged to complete the record of pilot time on the FAA Form 8710-11 application. The FAA Form 8710-11 application will remain on file with the FAA and can be used to substantiate past aeronautical experience if a person were to ever lose their logbook.

NOTE: If the applicant is retesting after a failure, the FAA Form 8710-11 application must be endorsed on the reverse side of the form by the applicant's flight instructor.

3) A pilot certificate.

4) A flight instructor certificate, if for recent experience or reinstatement of privileges.

5) A flight instructor certificate, if for a proficiency check.

6) A current airman medical certificate or a valid U.S. driver's license, if acting as PIC.

7) Knowledge test report(s) (see Figure 5-55, Sample of Computer-Generated Airman Knowledge Test Report) or authorization to use alternate criteria for the FOI test, if for initial issuance.

8) An FAA-approved pilot school graduation certificate, if applicable.

9) The aircraft maintenance records.

10) The aircraft Airworthiness Certificate and operating limitations or approved flight manual for each aircraft to be used.

11) The aircraft registration.

12) The Federal Communications Commission (FCC) license, if required.

13) An acceptable form of photo identification.

B. Obtain Documents When Applicant Arrives for Appointment.

1) Collect and review the documents and records listed in subparagraph A above.

2) An ASI or an AST will open a SAS AR record.

C. Review the Application. Verify that the information on the FAA Form 8710-11 application is presented accurately and completely.

1) On FAA Form 8710-11, section I, ensure that the applicant has checked "Flight Instructor," and noted "Initial," "Recent Experience," or "Reinstatement," as appropriate to the practical test being requested.

2) Ensure that the remainder of the application is completed in accordance with the instructions attached to the form and the information provided in Volume 5, Chapter 1, Section 3.

3) If the applicant is applying for the original issuance of a flight instructor certificate with a sport pilot rating, or for a proficiency check for an additional category or class privilege, ensure that an authorized flight instructor has signed an endorsement within the 60 days prior to the practical test or proficiency check, as applicable.

D. Verify Applicant's Identity. Inspect acceptable forms of identification to establish the applicant's identity. Compare the identification with the personal information provided on the FAA Form 8710-11 application. (See Volume 5, Chapter 1, Section 3.)

1) If the applicant's identity can be verified, proceed with the task.

2) If the applicant's identity cannot be verified because of lack of identification or inadequate identification, explain what types of identification are acceptable. Advise the applicant to return with the appropriate identification to reapply. Return all application documents to the applicant.

3) If the applicant's identity appears to be different from the information supplied on the application or it appears that an attempt at falsification has been made, do not continue with this task. (See Volume 5, Chapter 1, Section 3, Paragraph 5-55, Verification of Applicant's Identity, for further information.)

E. Establish Eligibility. For the original issuance of a flight instructor certificate with a sport pilot rating or an additional category or class privilege, determine if the applicant meets the general eligibility, aeronautical knowledge, and flight proficiency requirements for the flight instructor certificate (refer to 14 CFR §§ 61.403 through 61.411).

1) Determine if the applicant holds at least a sport pilot certificate or higher with the appropriate category/class privilege or rating sought.

2) Verify that the applicant holds at least a current third-class airman medical certificate, is eligible under BasicMed, or holds a valid U.S. driver's license, if applicable.

3) If the applicant is applying on the basis of graduation from an approved training program under 14 CFR part 141 or 142 for a practical test, or for a proficiency check for an additional category or class privilege, inspect the applicant's graduation certificate. Verify that the applicant meets the requirements of 14 CFR § 61.71(a), which requires the applicant's graduation certificate to be dated within the 60-day period after the date of graduation.

4) Examine the applicant's logbooks and/or other reliable record(s) to verify that all aeronautical knowledge and flight proficiency requirements are recorded. Verify that the required endorsements for ground and flight instruction have been certified by an authorized flight instructor.

5) Have the applicant present evidence of satisfactory completion of a course(s) of instruction in the subjects listed in 14 CFR §§ 61.407 and 61.409, or an acceptable equivalent.

6) For initial issuance, as applicable to the flight instructor category or class privilege sought, inspect the applicant's knowledge test report(s) or authorization to use acceptable alternative criteria in lieu of the FOI test.

7) If a flight instructor is applying to establish flight instructor recent experience, determine whether the flight instructor is within their preceding recent experience period. If the flight instructor's recent experience has lapsed, advise the applicant that their flight instructor privileges have lapsed and that they must reinstate their flight instructor privileges, in accordance with 14 CFR § 61.427.

8) If the applicant is reapplying for the test after a failure (i.e., if the "Yes" box of section IV of the FAA Form 8710-11 application is checked), verify that the applicant meets the requirements of 14 CFR § 61.49, if appropriate.

F. Verify Aircraft Requirements. Review the aircraft's Airworthiness Certificate, aircraft registration, and aircraft maintenance records or logbooks for the last annual condition inspection, 100-hour inspection, if applicable, for all required inspections for installed equipment, and compliance with applicable Airworthiness Directives (AD) and safety directives to determine if the aircraft is in a safe condition for flight and suitable for this practical test. Verify that the aircraft (airplane or glider) to be used is certificated for spins, if required. Aircraft used must meet the sport pilot aircraft performance and design limitations listed in 14 CFR § 61.316. After reviewing the documents, return them to the applicant.

G. Resolve Discrepancies. If a discrepancy that cannot be immediately corrected exists in any of the aircraft documents, return the application and all submitted documents to the applicant. Inform the applicant of the reasons for ineligibility and explain how the applicant may correct the discrepancies.

H. Administer Practical Test or Proficiency Check. After determining that the applicant is eligible and meets all prerequisites for the flight instructor certificate and associated rating(s) or privilege(s) sought, accept the FAA Form 8710-11 application and administer the practical test or proficiency check in accordance with the guidance in the PTS or ACS, as appropriate.

1) If the practical test or proficiency check is not completed for reasons other than unsatisfactory performance, issue a Letter of Discontinuance to the applicant. (See Figure 5-54, Sample Letter of Discontinuance.)

2) Return the application and all submitted documents to the applicant with the original of the Letter of Discontinuance.

3) Explain how the applicant may complete the practical test or proficiency check at a later date.

4) Close SAS AR.

I. Resolve an Unsatisfactory Performance—Practical Test. Upon determining that an applicant's practical test performance is unsatisfactory, discontinue the practical test and inform the applicant of the reason(s) why the area of operation was unsatisfactory. However, the evaluator has the option to continue the practical test if the applicant agrees; this allows the applicant the chance to complete the other required areas of operation and associate tasks.

1) Prepare FAA Form 8060-5 in duplicate, per Volume 5, Chapter 1, Section 6.

a) Record any specific procedures or maneuvers that must be repeated by the applicant on FAA Form 8060-5.

b) Record the number of practical test failures by the applicant for this certificate or rating on FAA Form 8060-5.

2) As appropriate, mail the completed certification file to the managing FSDO no later than 7 calendar days after the completion of the test. Forward the completed file to AFG-970. Integrated Airman Certification and Rating Application (IACRA) files may be sent directly to AFB-720.

3) Complete the application and return all other submitted documents to the applicant.

4) As appropriate, sign an entry in the applicant's records after the practical test. That entry must show the type of test, the duration of the flight portion, the unsatisfactory outcome of the test, and the evaluator's designation number.

J. Resolve an Unsatisfactory Performance—Proficiency Check. Upon determining that an applicant's proficiency check performance is unsatisfactory, discontinue the proficiency check and inform the applicant of the reason(s) why the area of operation was unsatisfactory. However, the evaluator has the option to continue the practical test if the applicant agrees; this allows the applicant the chance to complete the other required areas of operation and associated tasks.

1) As appropriate, mail the completed certification file to the managing FSDO no later than 7 calendar days after the completion of the test. Forward the completed file to AFG-970. IACRA files may be sent directly to AFB-720.

2) Complete the application and return all other submitted documents to the applicant.

3) As appropriate, sign an entry in the applicant's records after the proficiency check. That entry must show the type of test, the duration of the flight portion, the unsatisfactory outcome of the test, and the evaluator's designation number.

K. Resolve a Satisfactory Performance—Practical Test. Issue FAA Form 8060-4 to an applicant who meets all requirements for a flight instructor certificate.

1) Endorse the appropriate flight instructor privilege in the applicant's logbook.

2) Enter the following rating on the certificate:

a) For a sport pilot rating, place the following notation in section XIII of FAA Form 8060-4: "VALID ONLY WHEN ACCOMPANIED BY PILOT CERTIFICATE NO. [enter number]."

b) If the applicant is eligible for a Gold Seal Flight Instructor Certificate, enter the notation "GOLD SEAL CERTIFICATE" in the block containing the "Original Issuance/Reissuance" boxes on FAA Form 8060-4. See paragraph 5-538 above.

3) Verify that all information on FAA Form 8060-4 is correct. Sign the form and direct the applicant to sign line vii.

4) Retain the original FAA Form 8060-4 for the certification file and give the applicant a copy of the form.

5) Complete the appropriate portions on the reverse side of the FAA Form 8710-11 application. Sign the FAA Form 8710-11 application.

6) Forward the completed file to AFG-970.

7) Return to the applicant all submitted documents not forwarded to AFG-970.

L. Resolve a Satisfactory Performance—Proficiency Check.

1) Endorse the appropriate flight instructor privilege in the applicant's logbook.

2) Complete the appropriate portions on the reverse side of the FAA Form 8710-11 application. Sign the application.

3) Forward the completed file to AFG-970.

4) Return to the applicant all submitted documents not forwarded to AFG-970.

M. Close SAS AR. An ASI or an AST will complete a SAS AR record.

5-545 TASK OUTCOMES. Completion of this task results in the issuance of one of the following:

- FAA Form 8060-4, Temporary Airman Certificate;
- FAA Form 8060-5, Notice of Disapproval of Application;
- Letter of Discontinuance; or
- Endorsement of category and class privileges.

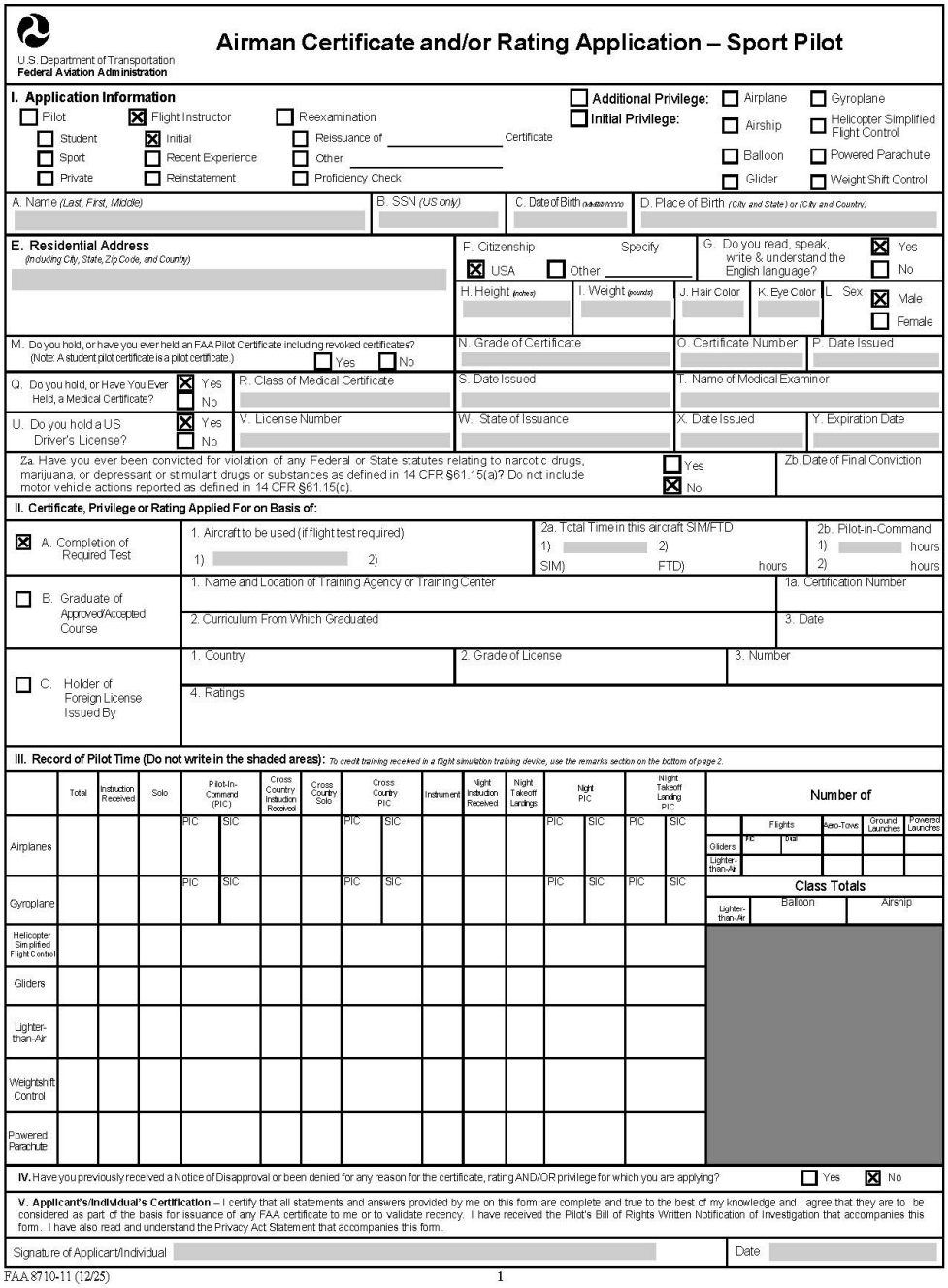
5-546 FUTURE ACTIVITIES.

- The applicant may return to establish flight instructor recent experience, reinstate flight instructor privileges, or retest after failure, if appropriate.
- The applicant may return for an additional flight instructor privilege.
- The applicant may return to apply for a Gold Seal Flight Instructor Certificate.

Figure 5-53. Sample FAA Form 8710-11, Application for a Flight Instructor Privilege for Sport Pilot

NOTE: The shaded areas of the form need to be completed with the appropriate information.

NOTE: Flight instructors establishing recent experience or reinstating privileges for flight instructor certificates issued after December 1, 2024, will not require a Temporary Airman Certificate, except for recent experience or reinstatement based on a practical test for an additional flight instructor rating.



U.S. Department of Transportation
Federal Aviation Administration

Airman Certificate and/or Rating Application – Sport Pilot

I. Application Information

☐ Pilot ☒ Flight Instructor ☐ Reexamination
☐ Student ☒ Initial ☐ Reissuance of _____ Certificate
☐ Sport ☐ Recent Experience ☐ Other _____
☐ Private ☐ Reinstatement ☐ Proficiency Check

☐ Additional Privilege: ☐ Initial Privilege:
☐ Airplane ☐ Airship ☐ Balloon ☐ Glider
☐ Gyroplane ☐ Helicopter Simplified Flight Control ☐ Powered Parachute ☐ Weight Shift Control

A. Name (Last, First, Middle)	B. SSN (US only)	C. Date of Birth (mm/dd/yyyy)	D. Place of Birth (City and State) or (City and Country)

E. Residential Address (Including City, State, Zip Code, and Country)	F. Citizenship: ☒ USA ☐ Other _____ Specify	G. Do you read, speak, write & understand the English language? ☒ Yes ☐ No

H. Height (inches)	I. Weight (pounds)	J. Hair Color	K. Eye Color	L. Sex ☒ Male ☐ Female

M. Do you hold, or have you ever held an FAA Pilot Certificate including revoked certificates? (Note: A student pilot certificate is a pilot certificate.) ☐ Yes ☐ No	N. Grade of Certificate	O. Certificate Number	P. Date Issued

Q. Do you hold, or Have You Ever Held, a Medical Certificate? ☒ Yes ☐ No	R. Class of Medical Certificate	S. Date Issued	T. Name of Medical Examiner

U. Do you hold a US Driver's License? ☒ Yes ☐ No	V. License Number	W. State of Issuance	X. Date Issued	Y. Expiration Date

Za. Have you ever been convicted for violation of any Federal or State statutes relating to narcotic drugs, marijuana, or depressant or stimulant drugs or substances as defined in 14 CFR §61.15(a)? Do not include motor vehicle actions reported as defined in 14 CFR §61.15(c). ☐ Yes ☒ No	Zb. Date of Final Conviction

II. Certificate, Privilege or Rating Applied For on Basis of:

☒ A. Completion of Required Test	1. Aircraft to be used (if flight test required) 1) 2)	2a. Total Time in this aircraft SIM/FTD 1) 2) SIM) FTD) hours	2b. Pilot-in-Command 1) hours 2) hours
☐ B. Graduate of Approved/Accepted Course	1. Name and Location of Training Agency or Training Center		1a. Certification Number
	2. Curriculum From Which Graduated		3. Date
☐ C. Holder of Foreign License Issued By	1. Country	2. Grade of License	3. Number
	4. Ratings		

III. Record of Pilot Time (Do not write in the shaded areas): *To credit training received in a flight simulation training device, use the remarks section on the bottom of page 2.*

	Total	Instruction Received	Solo	Pilot-In-Command (PIC) PIC	Pilot-In-Command (PIC) SIC	Cross Country Instruction Received	Cross Country Solo	Cross Country PIC PIC	Cross Country PIC SIC	Instrument	Night Instruction Received	Night Takeoff Landings	Night PIC PIC	Night PIC SIC	Night Takeoff Landing PIC PIC	Night Takeoff Landing PIC SIC
Airplanes				PIC	SIC			PIC	SIC				PIC	SIC	PIC	SIC
Gyroplane				PIC	SIC			PIC	SIC				PIC	SIC	PIC	SIC
Helicopter Simplified Flight Control																
Gliders																
Lighter-than-Air																
Weightshift Control																
Powered Parachute																

Number of

	Flights		Aero-Tows	Ground Launches	Powered Launches
	Pilot	Dual			
Gliders					
Lighter-than-Air					

Class Totals

Lighter-than-Air	Balloon	Airship

IV. Have you previously received a Notice of Disapproval or been denied for any reason for the certificate, rating AND/OR privilege for which you are applying? ☐ Yes ☒ No

V. Applicant's/Individual's Certification – I certify that all statements and answers provided by me on this form are complete and true to the best of my knowledge and I agree that they are to be considered as part of the basis for issuance of any FAA certificate to me or to validate recency. I have received the Pilot's Bill of Rights Written Notification of Investigation that accompanies this form. I have also read and understand the Privacy Act Statement that accompanies this form.

Signature of Applicant/Individual _____ Date _____

FAA 8710-11 (12/25) 1

Figure 5-53. Sample FAA Form 8710-11, Application for a Flight Instructor Privilege for Sport Pilot (Continued)

(SELECTED SECTIONS OF REVERSE SIDE)

NOTE: The shaded areas of the form need to be completed with the appropriate information.

NOTE: In order to add an additional airplane or helicopter–simplified flight controls privilege, the applicant must successfully complete a practical test with a Designated Examiner or ASI. To add other category and class privileges, an applicant may complete a proficiency check with a flight instructor. Refer to 14 CFR § 61.321.

Instructor's Recommendation

I have personally instructed the applicant and consider this person ready to take the test.

Date	Instructor's Signature (Print name & Sign)	Certificate Number	Recent Experience End Date

Air Agency's Recommendation

This applicant has successfully completed our _____ Course, and is recommended for certification, privilege or rating without further _____ test.

Date	Agency Name and Number	Official's Signature / Title

Designated Examiner or Airman Certification Representative Report

- ☐ Student Pilot Certificate Issued (Copy Attached)
- ☒ I have personally reviewed this applicant's pilot logbook and/or training record, and certify that the individual meets the pertinent requirements of 14 CFR part 61 for the pilot certificate, privilege or rating sought.
- ☐ I have personally reviewed this applicant's graduation certificate, and found it to be appropriate and in order, and have returned the certificate.
- ☒ I have personally tested and/or verified this applicant in accordance with pertinent procedures and standards with the result indicated below.
  - ☒ Approved – Temporary Certificate Issued (Original Attached) ☐ Approved – No Temporary Certificate Issued
  - ☐ Disapproved – Disapproval Notice Issued (Original Attached)

Location of Test (Facility, City, State)	Duration of Test: Ground	Simulator/FTD (SIM) / (FTD)	Flight 1) 2)

Certificate or Rating for which tested	Type(s) of Aircraft Used 1) 2)	Registration Number(s) 1) 2)

Date	Examiner's Signature (Print Name & Sign)	Certificate Number	Designation Number	Designation Expires

If application is for an additional category or class privilege, complete the following record. (Done by another instructor and goes straight to AFB-720, ASI fills out Aviation Safety Inspector section below.)

Proficiency Check – Instructor's Record

- ☒ I have successfully reviewed this applicants pilot logbook and/or training record and certify the individual meets the pertinent requirements of 14 CFR part 61 (Subparts K {61.419} or J {61.321} for the proficiency check sought.
- ☒ I have personally tested this applicant in accordance with the pertinent procedures and standards of 14 CFR part 61 (Subparts K or J), and find the applicant proficient in (Kind of certificate, category, and class) and (Make and model) aircraft.

Proficiency Check: ☒ Satisfactory ☐ Unsatisfactory

Date	Instructor's Signature (Print Name & Sign)	Certificate Number	Recent Experience End Date:

Figure 5-53. Sample FAA Form 8710-11, Application for a Flight Instructor Privilege for Sport Pilot (Continued)

If an ASI administers a practical test and/or issues a flight instructor certificate, complete the following report (as appropriate).

Aviation Safety Inspector or Technician Report

I have personally tested this applicant in accordance with or have otherwise verified that this applicant complies with pertinent procedures, standards, policies, and or necessary requirements with the result indicated below.

☒ Approved – Temporary Certificate Issued (Original Attached) ☐ Disapproved – Disapproval Notice Issued (Original Attached)
☐ Approved – No Temporary Certificate Proficiency Check: ☐ Satisfactory ☐ Unsatisfactory

Location of Test (Facility, City, State)	Duration of Test: Ground	Simulator/FTD (SIM) FTD)	Flight 1) 2)

Certificate or Rating for which tested	Type(s) of Aircraft Used 1) 2)	Registration Number(s) 1) 2)

☐ Student Pilot Certificate Issued
☐ Examiner's Recommendation ☐ ACCEPTED ☐ REJECTED
☐ Reissue or Exchange of Pilot Certificate
☐ Certificate or Rating Based on: ☐ Foreign License ☐ Approved Course Graduate ☐ Other Approved FAA Qualification Criteria

Flight Instructor ☐ Initial ☒ Added Rating/Privilege ☐ Recent Experience ☐ Reinstatement
Instructor Recency Based on: ☐ Activity ☐ WINGS ☐ Training Course ☐ Test ☐ Duties and Responsibilities

Training Course (FIRC) Name	Graduation Certificate Number	Date

Date	Inspector's Signature (Print Name & Sign)	Certificate Number	FAA District Office

If an ASI performs a proficiency check, complete the following report.

Aviation Safety Inspector or Technician Report

I have personally tested this applicant in accordance with or have otherwise verified that this applicant complies with pertinent procedures, standards, policies, and or necessary requirements with the result indicated below.

☐ Approved – Temporary Certificate Issued (Original Attached) ☐ Disapproved – Disapproval Notice Issued (Original Attached)
☐ Approved – No Temporary Certificate Proficiency Check: ☒ Satisfactory ☐ Unsatisfactory

Location of Test (Facility, City, State)	Duration of Test: Ground	Simulator/FTD (SIM) FTD)	Flight 1) 2)

Certificate or Rating for which tested	Type(s) of Aircraft Used 1) 2)	Registration Number(s) 1) 2)

☐ Student Pilot Certificate Issued
☐ Examiner's Recommendation ☐ ACCEPTED ☐ REJECTED
☐ Reissue or Exchange of Pilot Certificate
☐ Certificate or Rating Based on: ☐ Foreign License ☐ Approved Course Graduate ☐ Other Approved FAA Qualification Criteria

Flight Instructor ☐ Initial ☒ Added Rating/Privilege ☐ Recent Experience ☐ Reinstatement
Instructor Recency Based on: ☐ Activity ☐ WINGS ☐ Training Course ☐ Test ☐ Duties and Responsibilities

Training Course (FIRC) Name	Graduation Certificate Number	Date

Date	Inspector's Signature (Print Name & Sign)	Certificate Number	FAA District Office

This section must be completed for all application actions.

Attachments:
☐ Student Pilot Certificate (Copy)
☐ Knowledge Test Report (if appropriate)
☒ Temporary Airman Certificate (if appropriate)
☐ Notice of Disapproval
☐ Superseded Airman Certificate (if appropriate)

Airman's Identification (ID):		Applicant's/Airman's Information:	
Form of ID:		Name:	
Number:		Date of Birth:	
Expiration Date:		Certificate Number:	
Telephone Number:		Email Address:	

☒ Meets Aviation English Language Standard ☐ Does Not Meet Aviation English Language Standard ☐ Referred to FSO for Aviation English Language Standard Determination
REMARKS:

Figure 5-54. Sample Letter of Discontinuance

FAA Letterhead

[*Date*]

[*Applicant's name and address*]

Dear [*Applicant's Name*]:

On this date, [*enter date*], you successfully completed a portion of the practical test indicated below:

Certificate/Rating: [*Sport Pilot*]

Additional Aircraft Category Privilege: [*ASEL WSCL PPL Glider Rotorcraft-Gyroplane LTA Free Balloon LTA-Airship*]

Flight Instructor: [*Initial/Renewal/Reinstatement*]

Aircraft Used: [*Registration #:, Make/Model:*]

The practical test was discontinued because of: [*indicate reason*]

If application is made by [*enter date 60 days from date of test*], this letter may be used to show the following portions of the practical test which have been completed satisfactorily:

[*List areas of operation satisfactorily completed.*]

AFTER [*expiration date*], YOU MUST REPEAT THE ENTIRE TEST.

NOTE: This letter does not extend the expiration date(s) for your knowledge test results, your graduation certificate, airman medical certificate, or the required instructor endorsements.

Sincerely,

[*Examiner's signature*], Designation Number _____

Figure 5-55. Sample of Computer-Generated Airman Knowledge Test Report

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF TRANSPORTATION
Federal Aviation Administration
Computer Airman Knowledge Test Report

NAME: Doe, James David **APPLICANT ID:** 123456789
EXAM: Sport Pilot Flight Instructor—Airplane (SIA) **EXAM ID:** 50122020004612312
EXAM DATE: 03/04/04 **EXAM SITE:** LAS12345
SCORE: 92% **GRADE:** Pass **TAKE:** 1
Below are subject matter knowledge codes in which questions were answered incorrectly. For code descriptions, see the latest version of AC 60-25, Reference Materials and Subject Matter Knowledge Codes for Airman Knowledge Testing, available via the Internet: **http://www.airweb.faa.gov/rgl**. A single code may represent more than one incorrect response.
A65, B09

EXPIRATION DATE: 03/31/2006
S A M P L E

DO NOT LOSE THIS REPORT

Authorized instructor's statement. (If Applicable)

I have given Mr./Ms._____ additional instruction in each subject area shown to be deficient and consider the applicant competent to pass the test.
Last_____ Initial_____ Cert. No._____ Type_____
(Print Clearly)
Signature

FRAUDULENT ALTERATION OF THIS FORM BY ANY PERSON IS A BASIS FOR SUSPENSION OR REVOCATION OF ANY CERTIFICATES OR RATINGS HELD BY THAT PERSON.

ISSUED BY: ADMINISTRATOR
FEDERAL AVIATION ADMINISTRATION

RESERVED. Paragraphs 5-547 through 5-565.